Professional Assessment

The journey of obtaining my B.S. in computer science has been a very long and very insightful journey. In the past four years I have gained valuable foundational skills through the variety of courses I have taken, and through them, I learned which areas of computer science I am drawn to, as well as those I'm not. Along with my coursework, the past year I obtained a position as a Jr. Systems Analyst. This has given me real job experience, and it has guided my decision making around my future career path.

When I first started the computer science program, I was dead set on pursuing a career in software engineering. As I completed assignments in my courses, I gradually built a solid foundation in programming, learning valuable skills and best practices that will translate directly to the job field. Some of the important skills I picked up through programming include unit testing, best practices of software security, and knowledge around various data structures. It wasn't until my first database class that my career interest started to shift. I took a MySQL class, a MongoDB class, and used MongoDB again in a full-stack development class. These classes taught me another set of valuable skills and showed me that I enjoy working with data and databases. Through these I learned useful skills and concepts such as relational databases, database design, and data querying.

In January 2025, I obtained my position as a Jr. Systems Analyst, and I have since learned a vast amount from this job, which has also contributed to my career choice I want to pursue. When I first started, I had limited knowledge around the tools and software I would be using on a frequent occasion. Fast forward to the present, I now have valuable skills and understanding in Excel, Power BI, NetSuite, and the Azure Environment. I have also gained skills not related to software, such as administration concepts and team collaboration during projects. Through my course assignments and everyday tasks at my job, I know that I enjoy working with and analyzing data. This leads me to pursue a career path as a data analyst, with the goal of becoming a data engineer as I get more experienced.

For my ePortfolio, I feel that the two artifacts chosen display useful and relevant skills I have obtained throughout my years of school. To represent skills in software engineering and databases, the artifact I went with is a full stack web application project from a full stack development course. This project displays a wide variety of skills relating to these categories, some of which are displaying dynamic page views with handlebars, database CRUD functionality using HTTP methods through an admin SPA (single page application), and displaying data from a database on a front-end web page. To represent skills related to data structures, the artifact I chose to use is a contact service program from a previous software test course. This program displays important skills in creating and managing data structures, as well as proficiency in unit testing which is an extremely important principle in software development. By choosing these two artifacts for my ePortfolio, real abilities that will prove valuable in the workforce are put on display. Although these show a solid foundation and understanding in relevant computer science skills, I plan on learning and developing new skills specifically related to my career path, such as SQL and Python mastery, as well as ETL processes for data pipelines.